Instagram Performance Analytics

Sugar Cosmetics · 50,000 posts · Apr 2024 – Apr 2025

Insights & strategy for the marketing team | Prepared by Adarsh Shrikant Tiwari

Strong reach and steady output; deeper engagement is the gap

50,000
posts published

987.4M
total reach

147.7M
likes received

18.54%
avg engagement rate

1

Engagement is shallow

Likes are 81% of all engagement; saves and shares, the signals the algorithm rewards, are under 10%.

2

Format & timing aren't the levers

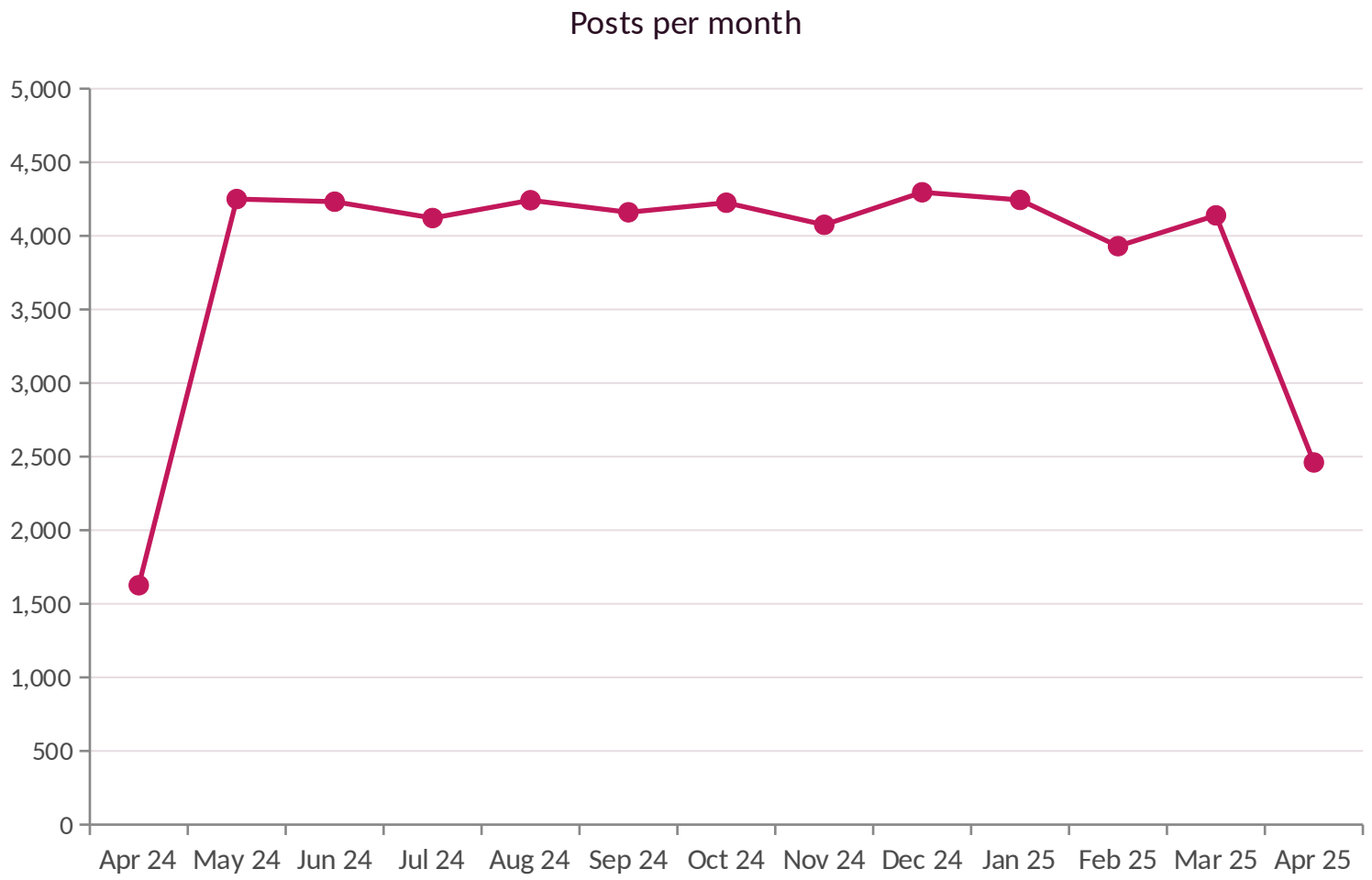
Every post type, weekday and month lands within 0.2 pp of the 18.5% average.

3

The profile converts well

30% of profile visitors follow — but only 3% of reached users visit the profile.

Posting is rock-steady at ~4,200 posts a month

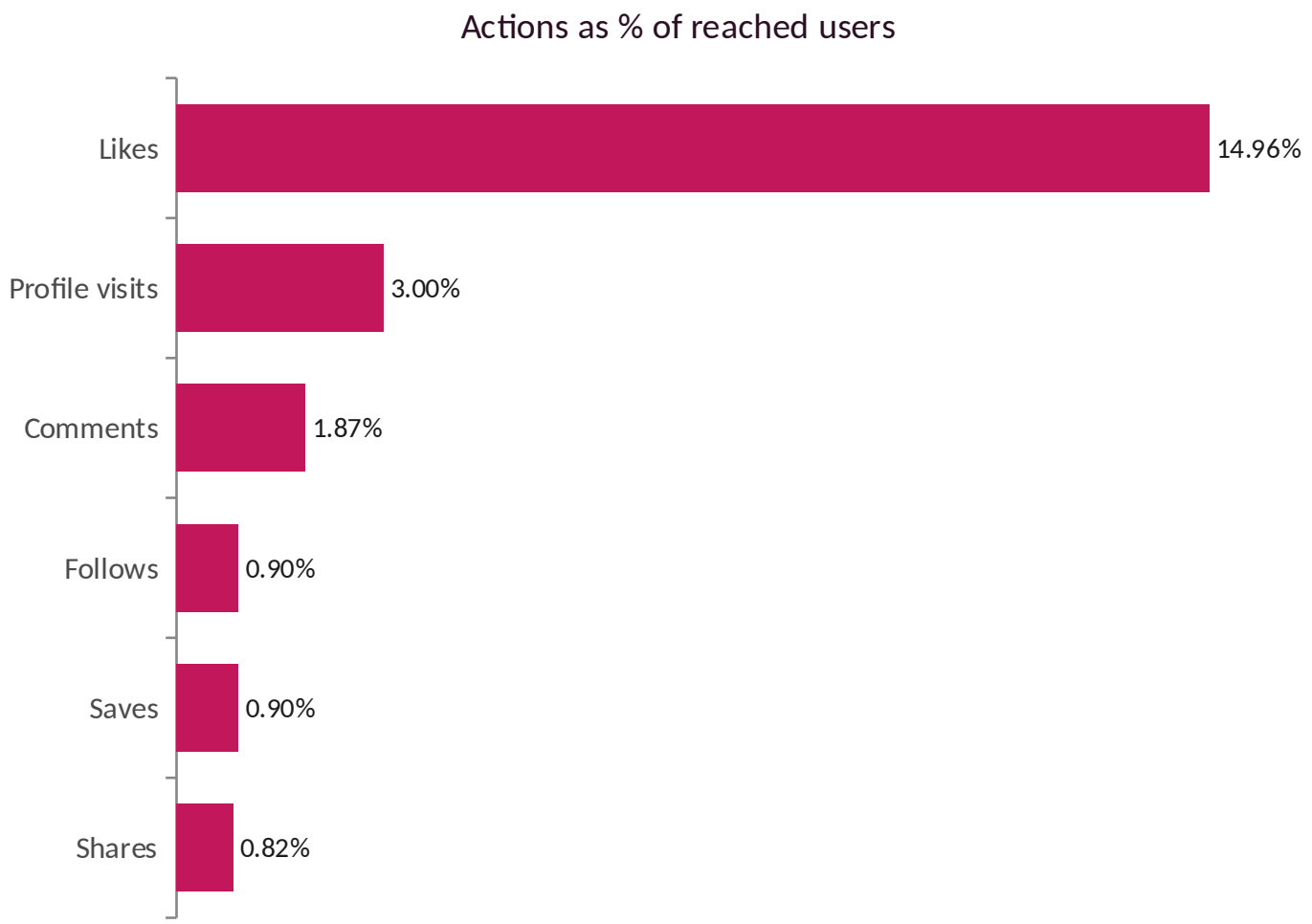


~137

posts per day on average

- Full months range 3,930 – 4,296 posts
- Apr 2024 and Apr 2025 are partial months
- Monthly ER stays between 18.3% and 18.7% — no seasonal spike or slump
- 8.9M new follows gained, growing evenly every month

Likes come easily — saves, shares and profile visits are the gap



81%

of all engagement is likes

77%

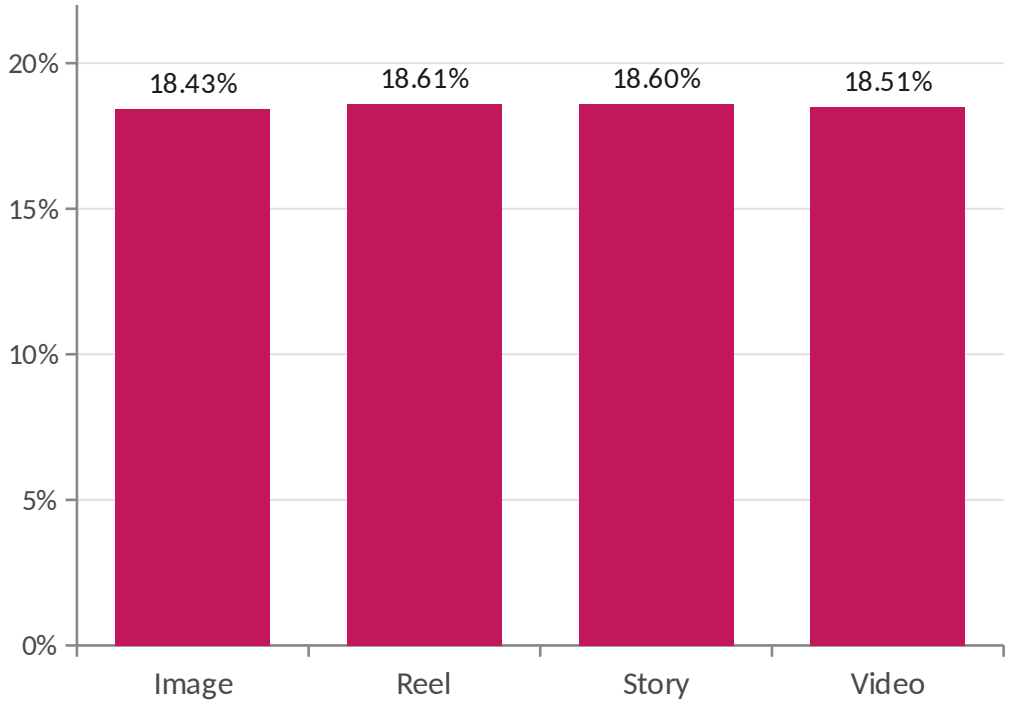
of impressions reach unique users

30%

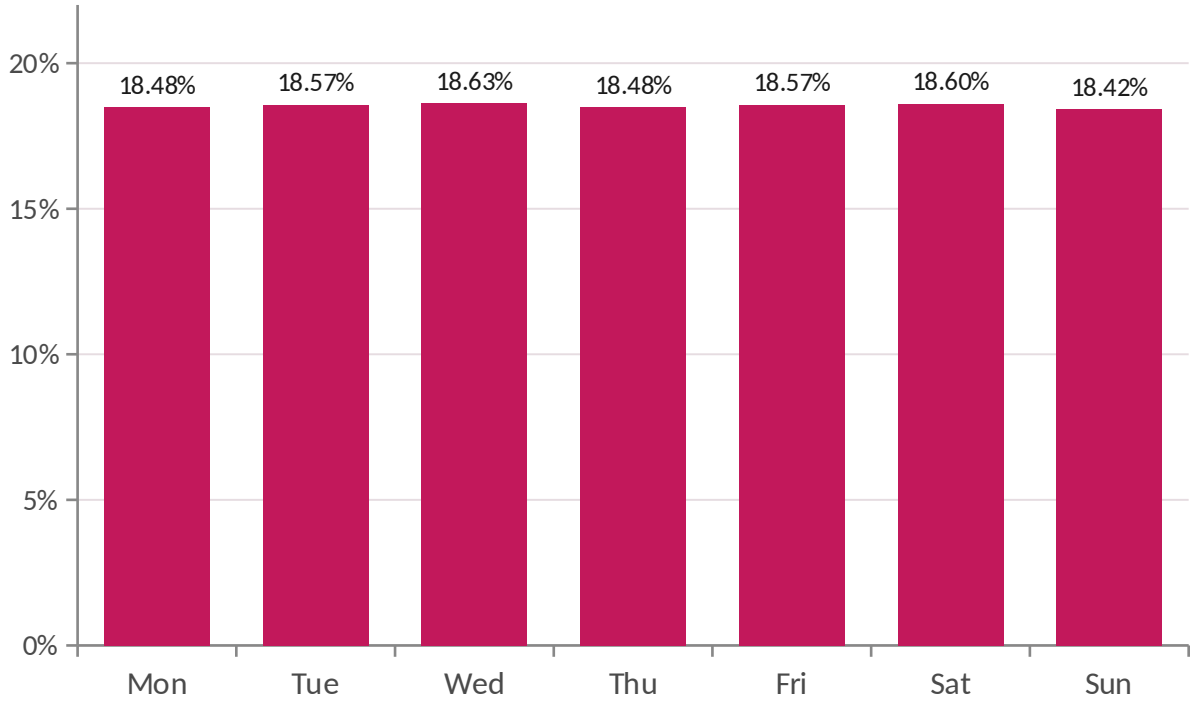
of profile visitors become followers

Format and weekday barely move engagement rate

Avg engagement rate by post type



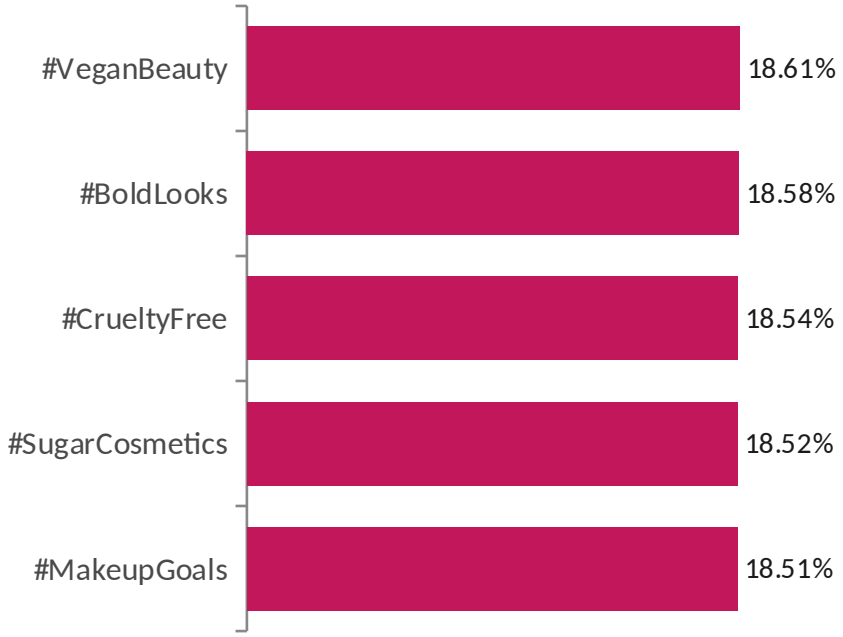
Avg engagement rate by weekday



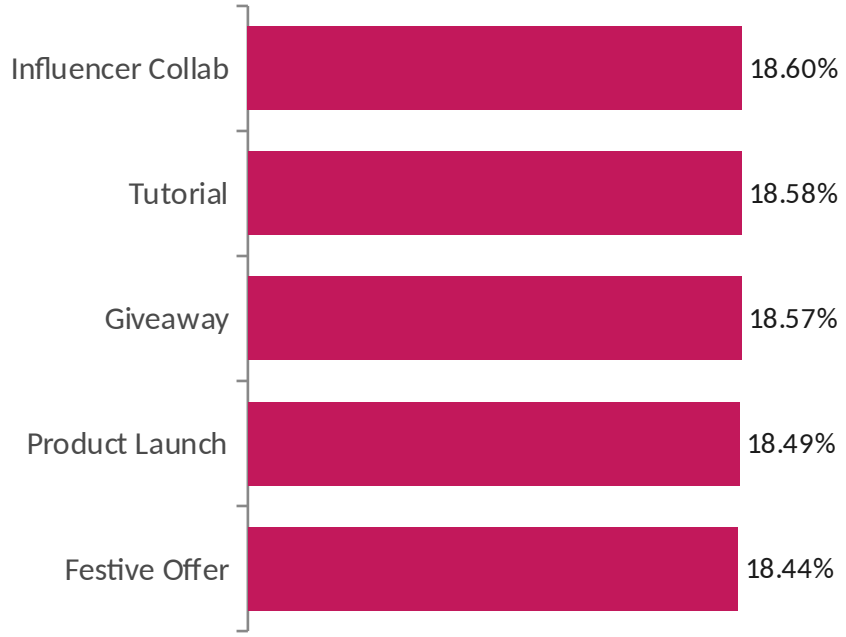
Best: Reel 18.61%, Story 18.60% · Wednesday 18.63%, Saturday 18.60%. **Weakest:** Image 18.43% · Sunday 18.42%. Gaps < 0.25 pp, not statistically significant.

Hashtags and campaigns give small but consistent edges

Avg ER by hashtag



Avg ER by campaign type



Best combo

18.80%

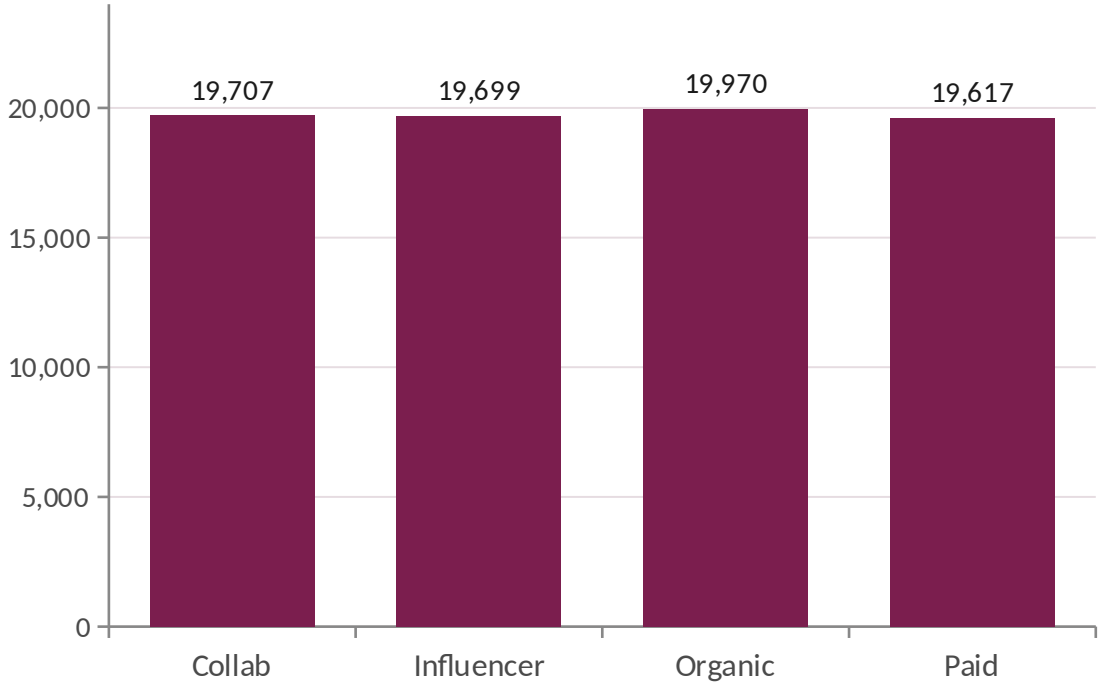
Story + Tutorial

Tutorials are the most common campaign among top-quartile posts (21%).

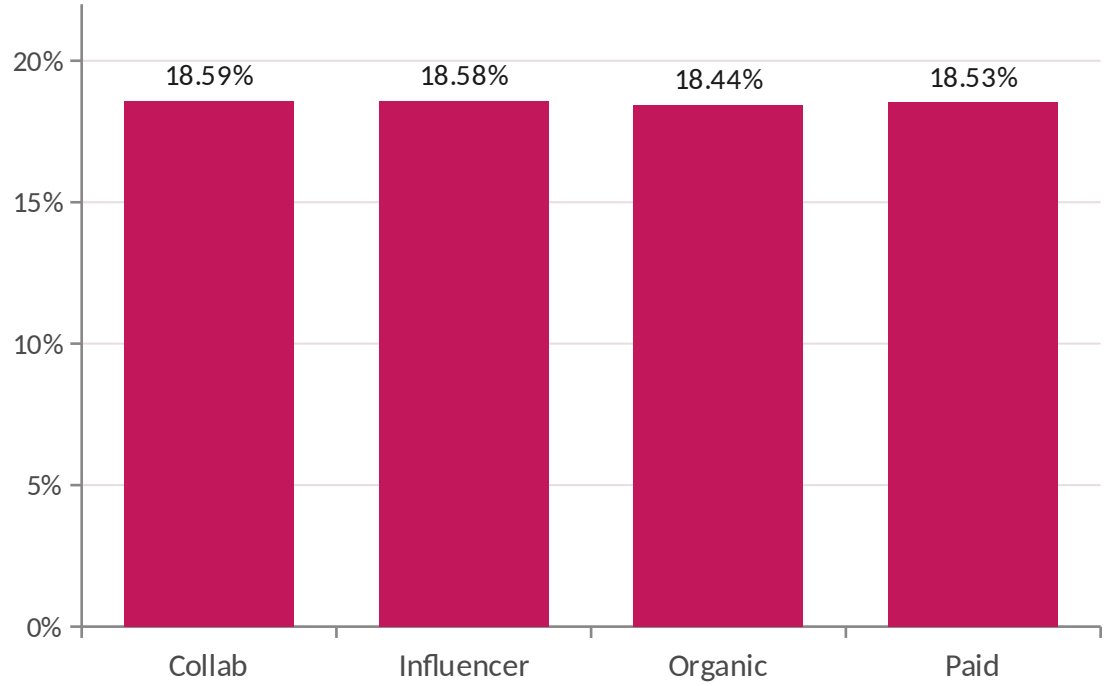
2 hashtags per post perform best (18.63%) vs 18.44% for a single tag — the closest result to significance (p = 0.054). #VeganBeauty and #BoldLooks lead; #MakeupGoals trails.

Paid promotion isn't buying extra reach or engagement

Avg reach per post by source



Avg engagement rate by source



Organic posts reach the most people (20.0K avg); Paid reaches 19.6K.

Hidden gems: e.g. post P48036 reached only 7.2K people yet hit 34% ER — boost posts like these.

Recommended posting strategy

Timing

Keep the steady 7-day schedule. Put launches and key campaigns on Wednesday, Friday or Saturday; keep Sunday light.

Frequency

Hold volume flat (~137/day). More posts aren't lifting ER — move effort from quantity to creative quality.

Content types

Lead with Reels and Stories. Prioritise Story + Tutorial and Reel + Influencer Collab; cut static-image offers.

Hashtags

Use 2–3 focused tags, never one. Prioritise #VeganBeauty and #BoldLooks; keep #SugarCosmetics as the brand tag.

Lift saves, shares and follows with value-first content

Design for saves & shares

Shade-finder carousels, swatch charts, step-by-step tutorials, "save this look" prompts.

Send people to the profile

Clear CTAs, pinned highlights and collab tags — 30% of visitors already follow.

Spark conversation

Questions, this-or-that polls in Stories, replies in the first hour.

Boost hidden gems

Shift paid budget from new posts to proven high-ER, low-reach posts.

Campaign ideas

Tutorial Wednesdays: 60-second Story looks with one hero product

#BoldLooks creator challenge: monthly collab Reels + reposted UGC

#VeganBeauty explainers: save-worthy ingredient carousels

Shade-match giveaway: comment your tone, follow + share to enter

Festive offers as Reels: "3 party looks under ₹999" instead of static images

Data gaps to close before the next review

Gap	Why it matters	Fix
No caption text	Can't test keywords, tone or CTAs	Export captions from Meta Business Suite
No posting hour	Can't recommend best time of day	Capture full timestamps; analyse hour × weekday
No follower count over time	Growth seen only via follows from posts	Track daily followers and unfollows
No ad spend	Can't compute paid ROI	Add spend per boosted post → cost per follow
Very uniform results	Category effects are tiny	Run A/B tests on format and timing
Carousel not tagged	Can't compare carousel vs image	Tag carousel posts as their own type

Next step: use the Streamlit dashboard monthly to track saves, shares and profile visits against these targets.